Action – Hide · SRD 5.2.1

The **Hide** action lets you **conceal yourself**. You need **cover** or **heavy obscurity** and must be **out of every enemy's line of sight**. You make a **Dexterity (Stealth) DC 15** check.

On a success you become **Invisible** while hidden. Your result becomes the **DC** enemies must beat to find you.

🎲 Quick summary:

1. **Dexterity (Stealth) DC 15** check.
2. Needs **heavy obscurity** or **three-quarters/total cover**.
3. Success: **Invisible**; the roll sets the **Perception** DC.
4. You're **found** if you make a noise, attack or cast with a Verbal component.

⚠ Change from 2014

SRD 2024 finally gives a fixed DC (15) and ties hiding to the **Invisible** condition. In 2014 it all depended on the DM.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

The SRD doesn't say how an enemy "finds" someone: it assumes a Wisdom (Perception) check against your roll. Fix: the **Search** action or passive Perception.

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can describe the scenery as help: shadows, a curtain, a grain sack, smoke.

Step 1 – Check conditions:

You're in **heavy obscurity** or behind **three-quarters or total cover**, **out of sight** of every enemy.

Step 2 – Act:

Spend the **Hide** action (or a bonus action if you have Cunning Action).

Step 3 – Roll:

1d20 + Dexterity + Stealth proficiency. DC **15**.

Step 4 – Stay hidden:

You are **Invisible** until you give yourself away. The roll's result is the enemies' Perception DC.

Step 5 – Get spotted:

A **noise louder than a whisper**, an **attack**, a **Verbal-component** spell or an enemy that succeeds reveals you.

Example: Ilsa slips behind a crate (three-quarters cover). She rolls 17 in Stealth: she is hidden. A guard rolls Perception 16: he doesn't see her.

Situation	Effect
You attack while hidden	Advantage on the attack, then you're revealed
An enemy attacks you	Disadvantage while it can't see you
You make a loud noise	You're revealed
You cast a Verbal-component spell	You're revealed
An enemy succeeds on Perception	It finds you (you stay visible to it)
You stay behind cover	You stay hidden

⚠ Common questions:

Must I be out of sight?

Yes, of every enemy.

What cover is enough?

Three-quarters, total or heavy obscurity.

What happens when I attack?

You attack with advantage, then you're revealed.

How does an enemy find me?

It beats your Stealth roll with Perception.

Does a whisper reveal me?

No, only a louder noise.

Can I hide in the open?

No, except with magic.

⚠ Debate points and table options: Table rule

Passive Perception

Can an enemy use passive Perception? **Option**: yes against the roll.

Staying hidden after attacking

The DM may rule the noise is faint. **Option**: a bow shot doesn't reveal you if you move.

Hiding behind an ally

Is a creature one size bigger cover? **Option**: no, unless the DM rules so.

Losing the state

You may choose to be spotted. **Option**: yes, at any time.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

Hide versus Search

Hiding sets a DC; Search is used to beat it.

Invisible

Hiding grants Invisible's effects while hidden.

Surprise

See the Surprise sheet (initiative with advantage).

These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.

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